

XTRIM STUDIOS

Where the money went

Commercial performance review · production, merch and advertising · January 2023 – June 2025

Prepared for the Studio Director · 14 September 2026

The answer in six sentences

Each one carries a number you can check in the appendix.

- 1 Revenue grew 31% in naira, from ~~₦~~7.07B in 2023 to ~~₦~~9.24B in 2024, but the dollar went from an average of ~~₦~~895 to ~~₦~~2,492, so that revenue was worth \$8.0M in 2023 and only \$3.6M in 2024.
- 2 ~~₦~~5.96B (30%) of the production work booked since January 2023 had not reached Completed when the data was exported, including ~~₦~~1.60B on 175 jobs from 2023–2024 still marked Invoiced.
- 3 Postponed work has more than doubled, from 5.9% of revenue in 2023 to 13.8% in the first half of 2025.
- 4 Studio Rental loses money on crew cost alone (-5.3% margin; 83 of 186 jobs), and across the business 182 jobs cost ~~₦~~140M more in crew than they earned.
- 5 The ~~₦~~860M spent on ads brought back ~~₦~~0.35 of tracked web-shop revenue per ~~₦~~1; they pay for themselves only if at least 6.7% of the ~~₦~~6.56B of bookings credited to Google, Instagram and TikTok came from a paid ad, and no system records whether they did.
- 6 Crew, ads and merch stock take only 17.1% of 2024 revenue, so the missing cash sits in what these systems do not record (dollar-priced kit and software, rent, salaries, tax) and in unpaid invoices, which is where finance should look first.

What we worked with, and what we threw away

Fourteen exports from five systems. Nothing was deleted; every rejected row is kept with a reason.

282,171

raw rows across 14 files

2,445

rows quarantined (0.87%), none deleted

6.9%

of revenue (₦1.44B) touched by issues we could not resolve

What was wrong

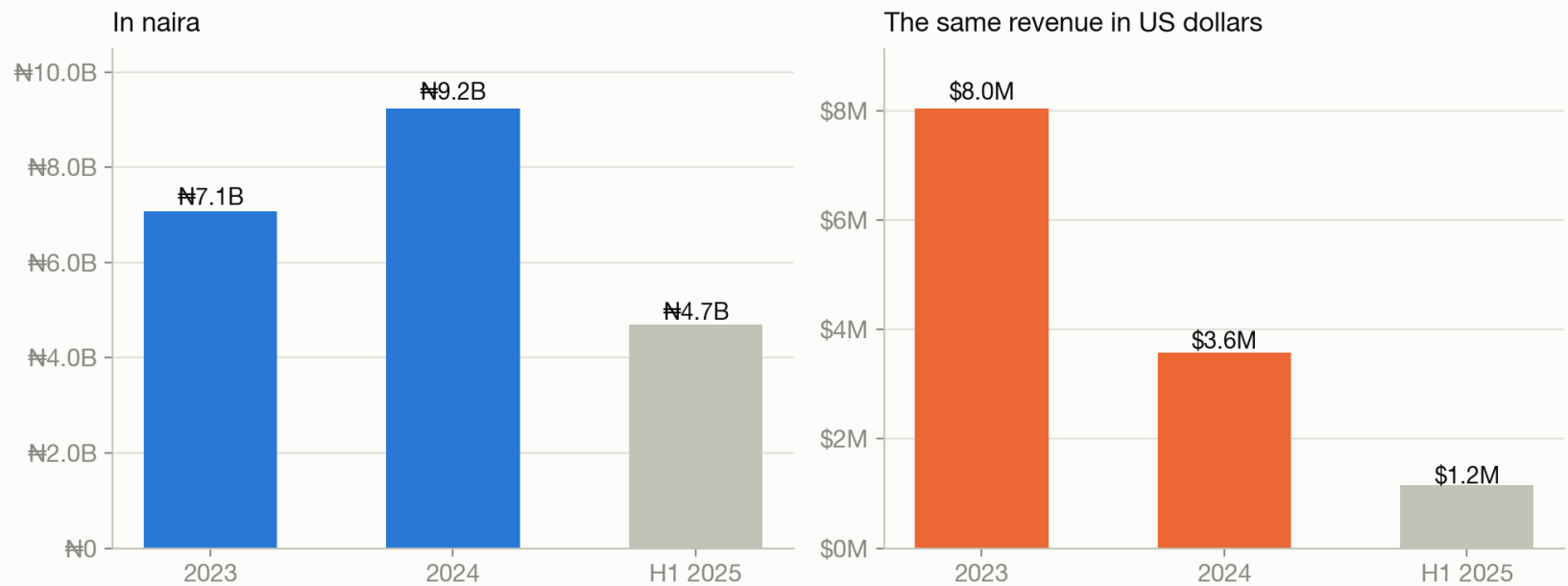
- 15 statements in the data dictionary are false
- 2024 booking dates are month-first; 2023 are day-first
- 124 duplicate clients re-keyed under new IDs, 58 exact repeats
- 23,054 bot visits (11%) and a 5,200-visit spam burst in the web data
- USD and GBP jobs never converted; now all naira at the daily rate
- Price history with 29 overlapping windows, resolved and enforced by the database
- 319 timesheets for jobs that don't exist; 129 shifts of 26 hours
- 115 jobs with no service type; kept as 'Unknown' because they couldn't be recovered reliably

Busier in naira, poorer in dollars

The naira collapse turned real growth into a real-terms decline.

Busier in naira, poorer in dollars

Revenue grew 30.6% in naira from 2023 to 2024 but fell 55.5% in dollars. H1 2025 (gray) is a half year.



Dollar value = each quarter's naira revenue at that quarter's average USD rate (core.fx_daily).

+31%

revenue growth in naira, 2023 → 2024

-56%

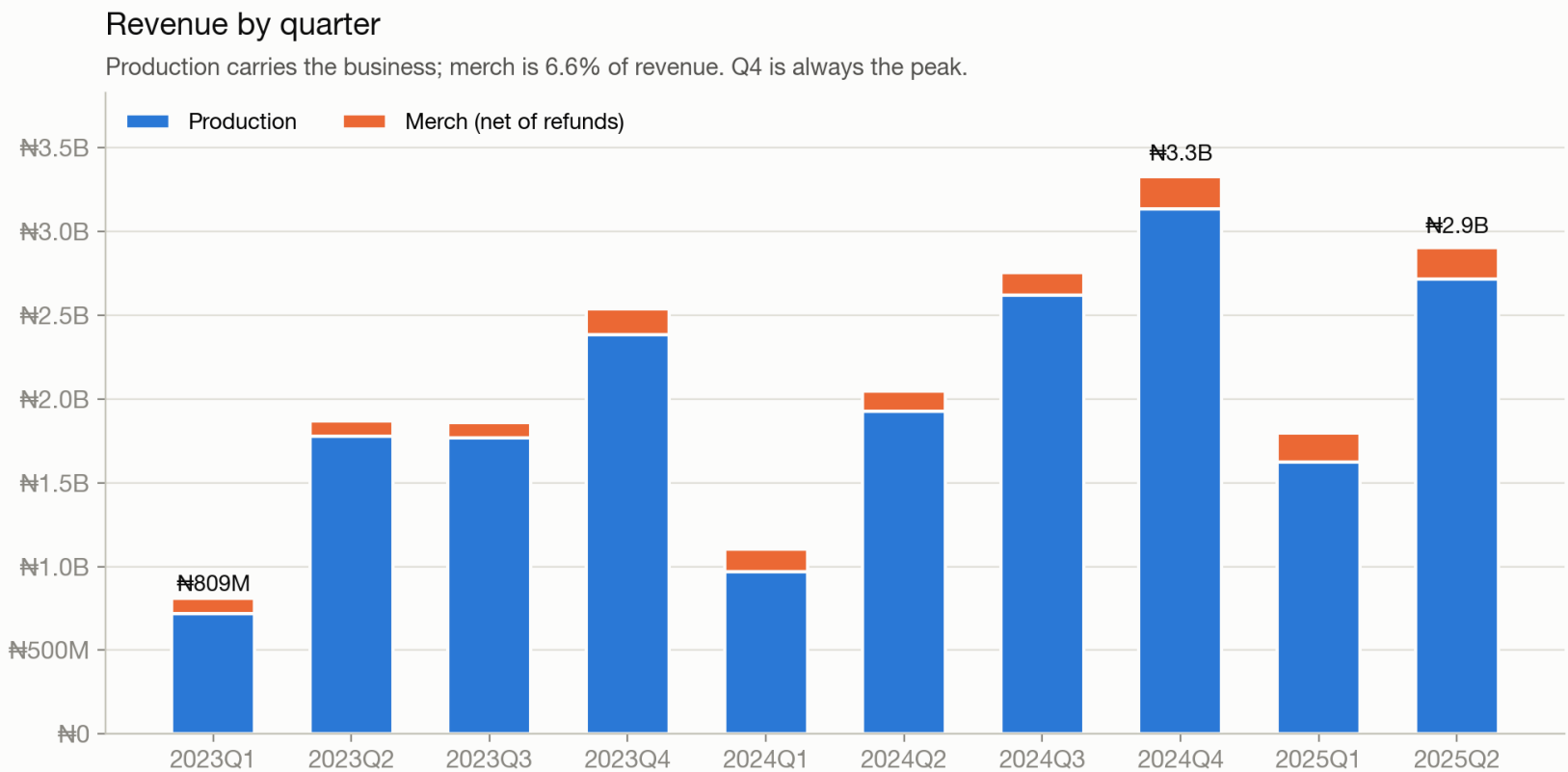
the same revenue in dollars

90%

value the naira lost against the dollar
(₦465 → ₦4,731)

Production carries the business

Revenue by quarter, production and merch.



Source: Xtrim Studios warehouse (core.*), NGN.

₦21.02B

total revenue, Jan 2023 – Jun 2025

6.6%

of revenue from merch

+49%

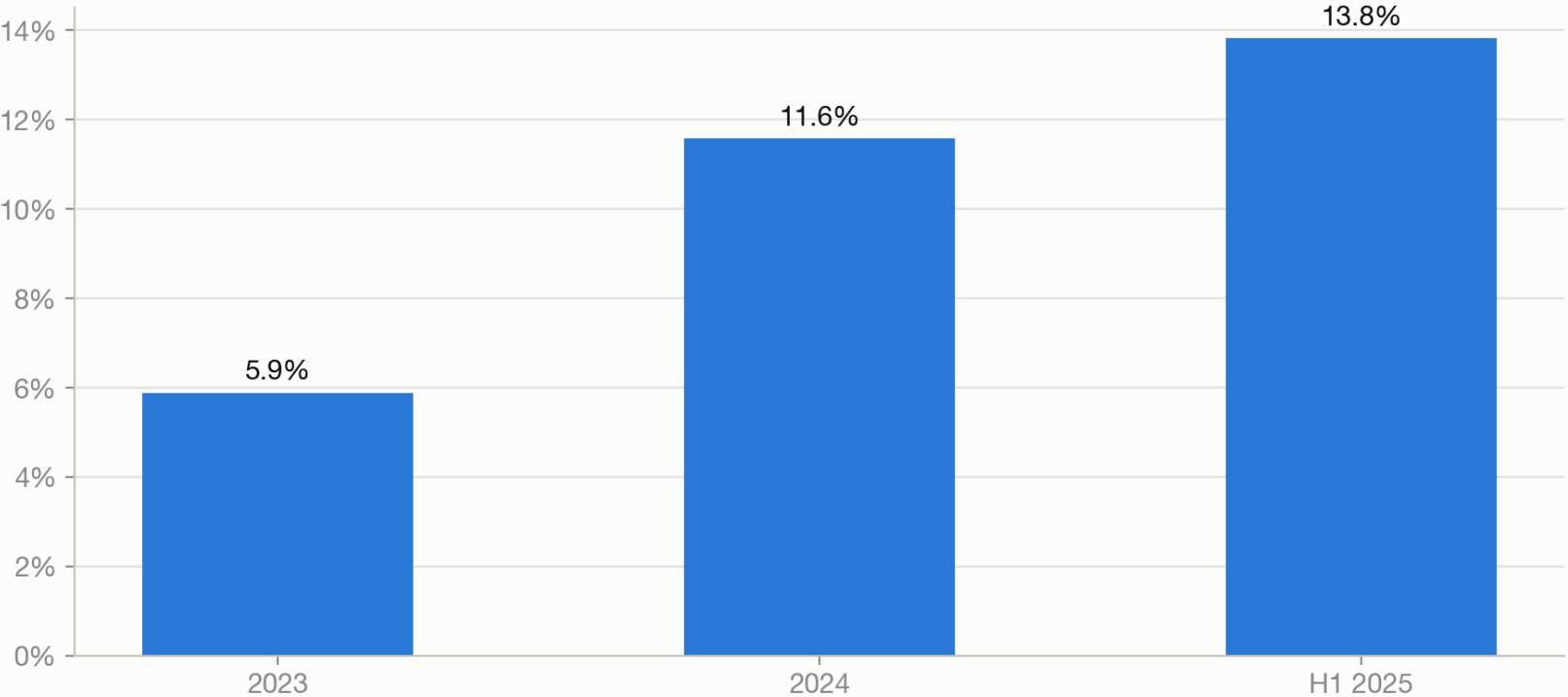
H1 2025 vs H1 2024, in naira

Booked is not banked

Almost a third of production revenue is in jobs that are not complete.

More booked work is slipping

Share of each year's production revenue sitting in Postponed jobs.



Source: core.fct_booking status at export (mid-2025).

~~₦~~**5.96B**

(30%) invoiced, in production, postponed or no status

~~₦~~**1.60B**

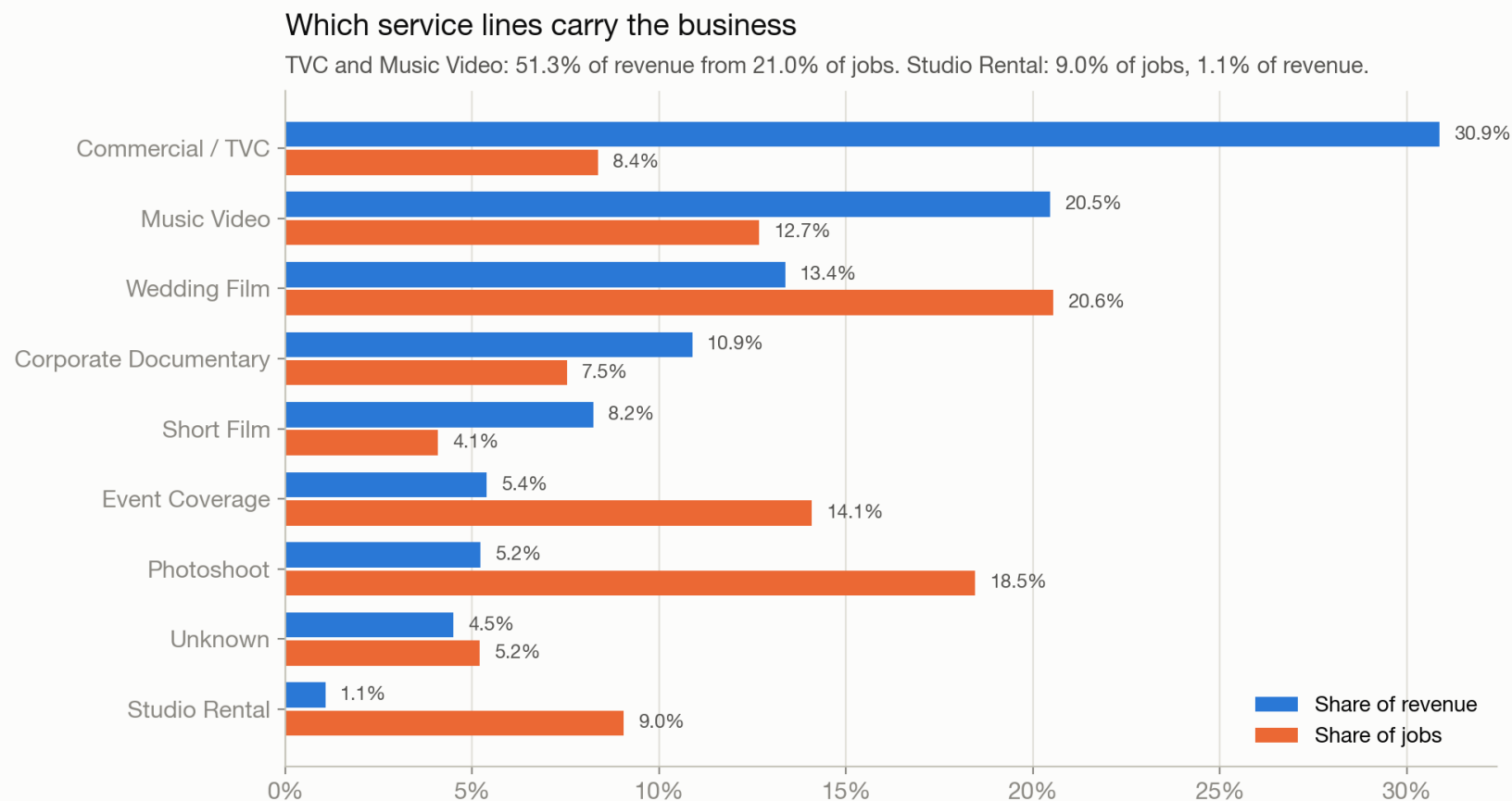
on 175 jobs from 2023–2024 still marked Invoiced

13.8%

of H1 2025 revenue postponed, up from 5.9% in 2023

Two service lines earn half the money

Share of revenue vs share of jobs.



Source: core.fct_booking, non-cancelled jobs 2023 – H1 2025. 'Unknown' = service type never recorded.

51%

of revenue from Commercial / TVC and Music Video, 21% of jobs

423

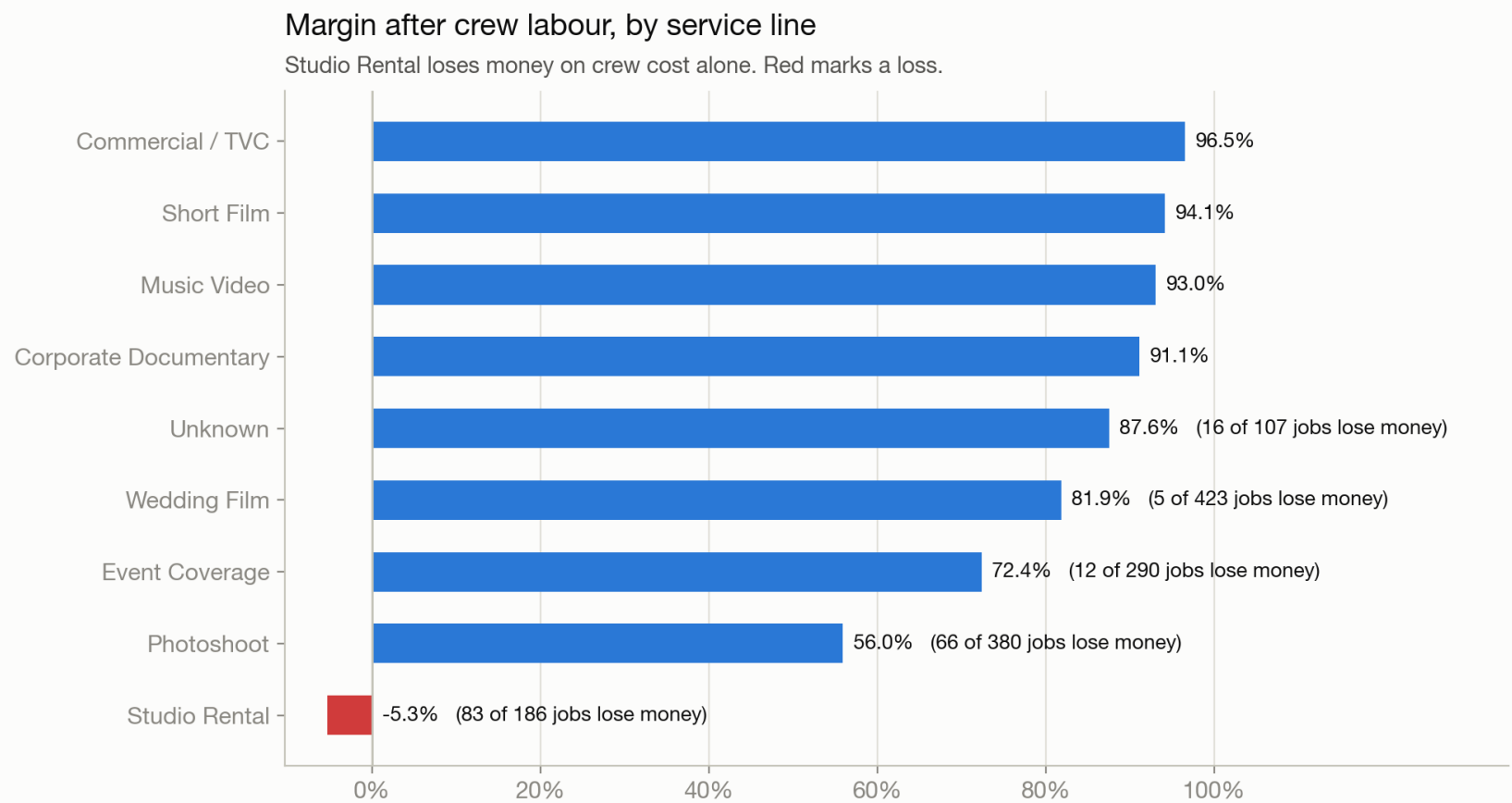
wedding jobs, the most of any line, but 13% of revenue

1.1%

of revenue from Studio Rental, 9% of jobs

Some jobs cost more in crew than they earn

Margin after crew day rates, by service line.



Margin = (net revenue – crew day rates) / net revenue. Non-cancelled jobs. Other costs (rent, kit) are not in the data.

-5.3%

Studio Rental margin; 83 of 186 jobs lose money

182

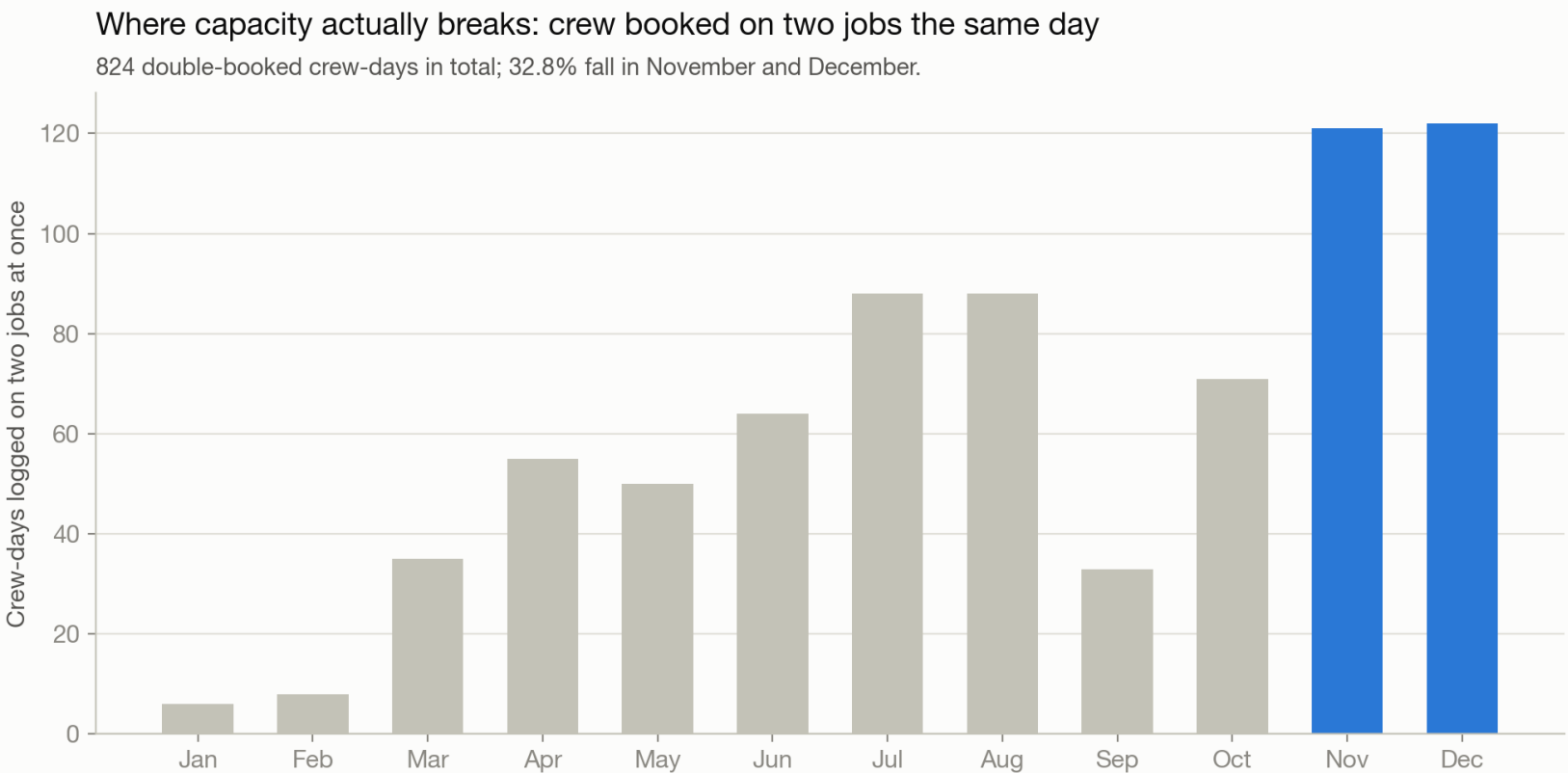
loss-making jobs, ₦140M lost in total

147 / 35

genuine losses / losses explained by bad timesheet data

Capacity breaks in November and December

Crew logged on two jobs on the same day, by month.



Source: core.fct_crew_day, 2023–2024. Utilisation never passed 85% in any week (peak 20.2%).

0

weeks above 85% crew utilisation
(peak 20%)

824

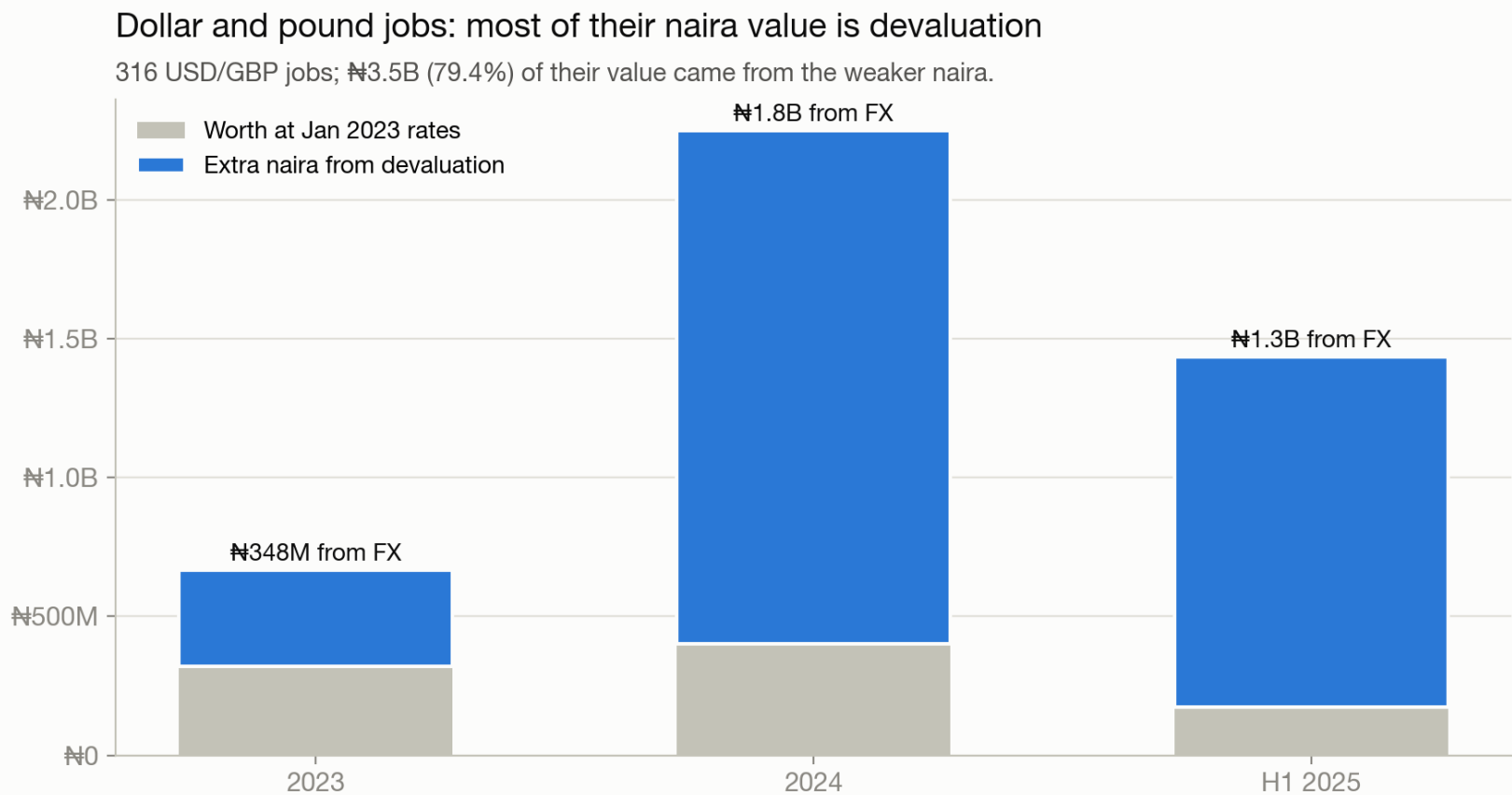
crew-days booked on two jobs at
once

33%

of those in November and December

Dollar and pound jobs held their value

Foreign jobs valued at the shoot-date rate vs the 1 January 2023 rate.



Each job valued at its shoot-date rate vs the 1 Jan 2023 rate. Non-cancelled jobs.

₦3.46B

extra naira on 316 USD/GBP jobs from devaluation

79%

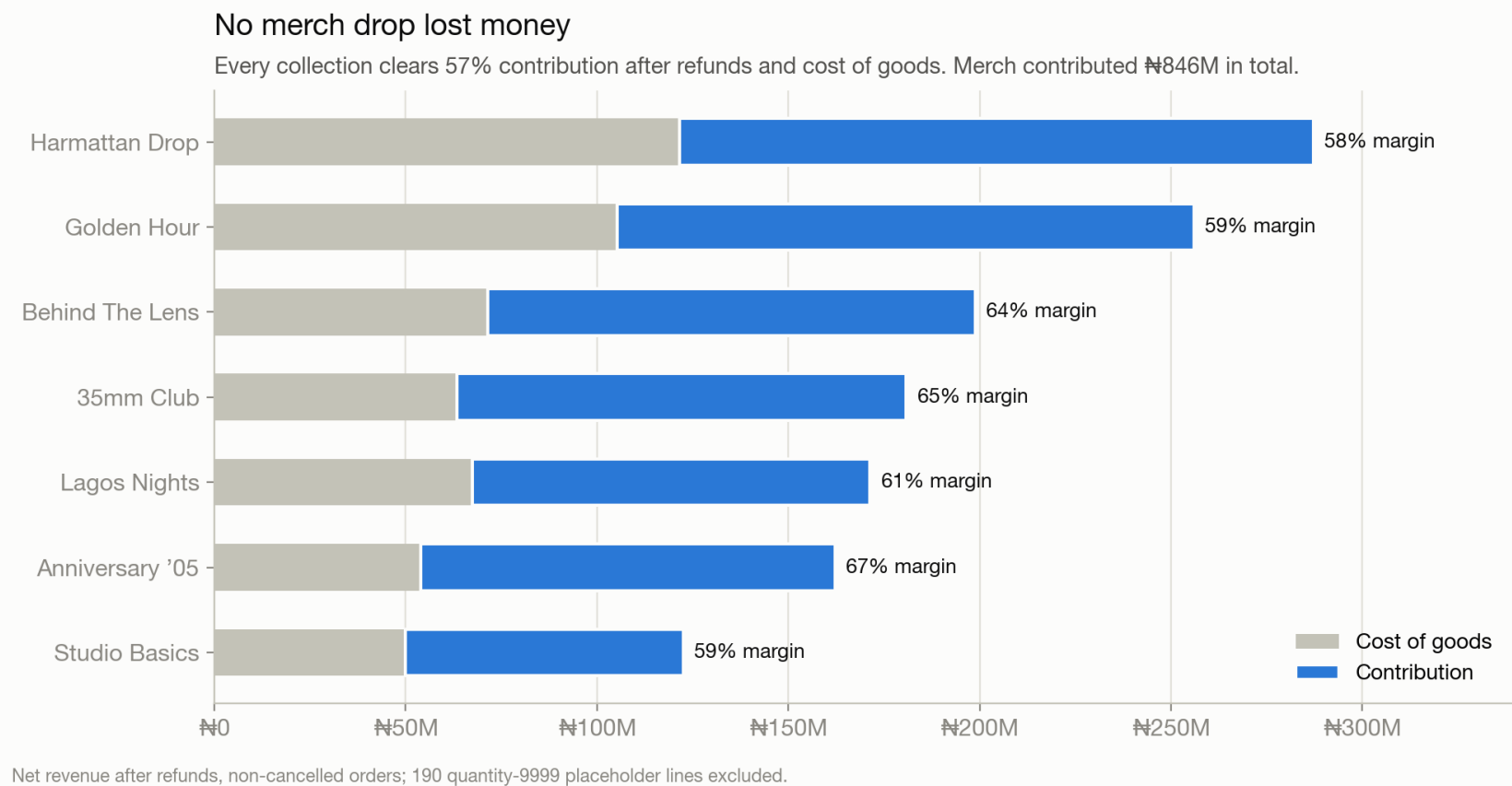
of those jobs' naira value is pure exchange rate

39%

of rates used were gap-filled (weekend or missing days)

Merch is healthy, but small

Contribution after refunds and cost of goods, by collection.



₦846M

merch contribution (61% of net revenue)

0

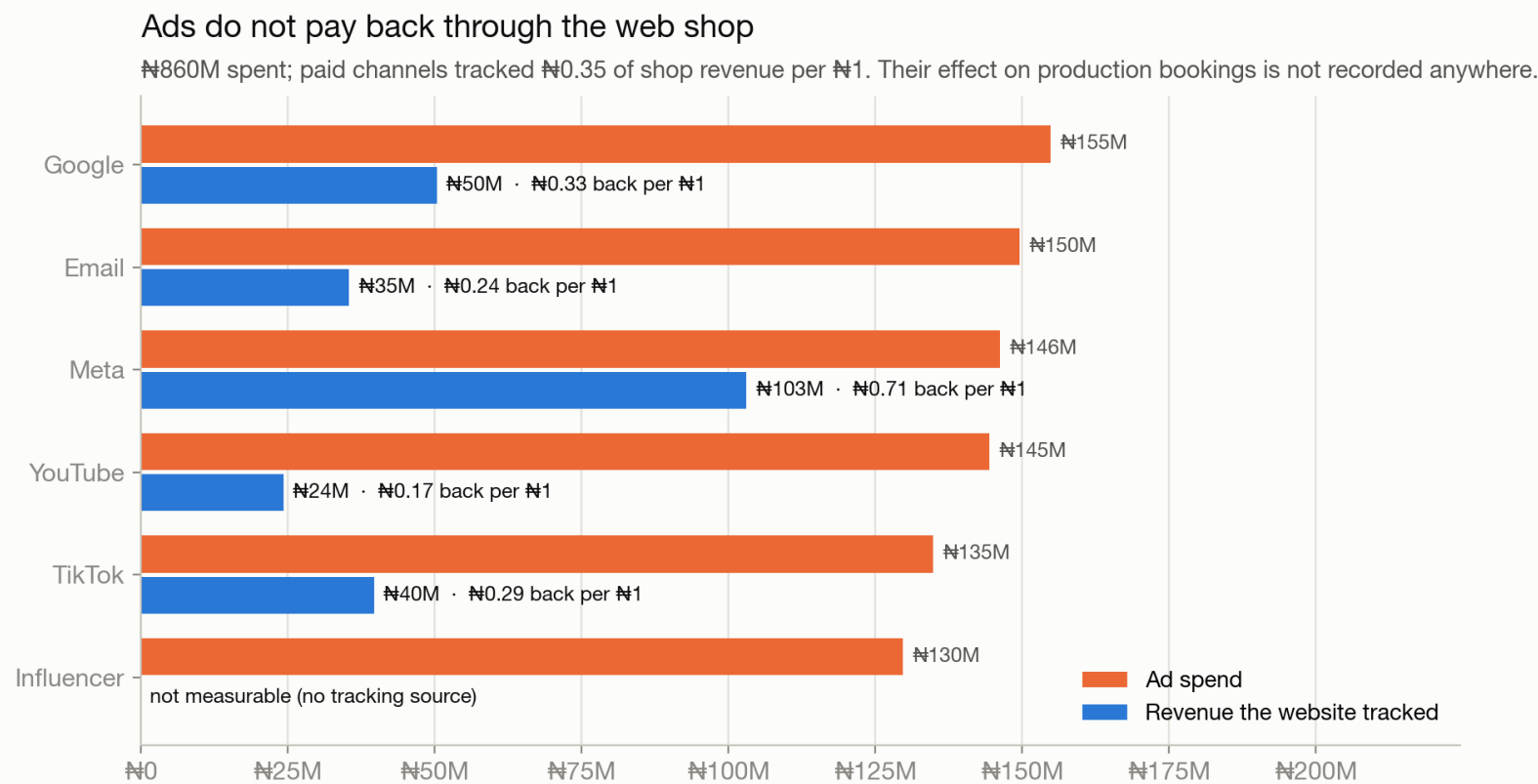
collections (drops) that lost money

9.5%

refund rate; no SKU above 2x (highest 1.31x)

Ads do not pay back through the web shop

Spend vs revenue the website tracked, by channel.



Human sessions only (bots removed). Revenue = what the analytics tool recorded on converting sessions, 2023 – H1 2025.

~~₦0.35~~

tracked web revenue per ₦1 of paid ads

6.7%

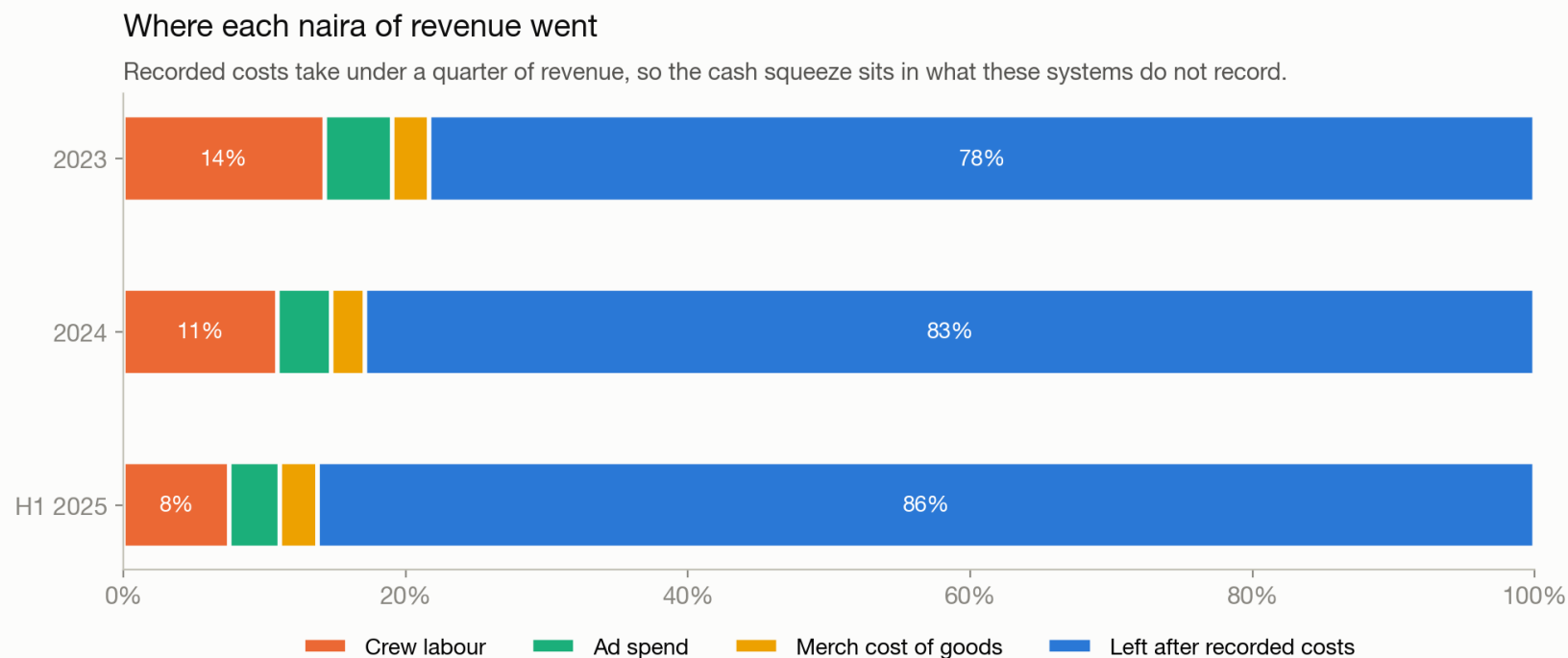
of ₦6.56B social-sourced bookings ads must drive to break even

68%

of recorded sales link to a real order

Where each naira went

Recorded costs take under a quarter of revenue.



Revenue = production (non-cancelled) + merch net. Rent, equipment, salaries, tax and overheads are not in the data.

21.7%

recorded costs ÷ revenue, 2023

17.1%

recorded costs ÷ revenue, 2024

13.8%

recorded costs ÷ revenue, H1 2025

What to do

Five moves, in order of how fast they put cash back.

1

Collect before you grow.

Chase the ₦1.60B of 2023–2024 invoices this quarter, take a deposit at booking, and charge for postponements.

2

Price in dollars where you can.

Quote Commercial, Music Video and international clients in USD or with an exchange-rate clause; it is the one lever that grew in value as the naira fell.

3

Fix or drop loss-making jobs.

Set a minimum price or a crew cap for Studio Rental and Photoshoot so no job costs more in crew than it earns.

4

Test the ads before spending more.

Add 'which ad?' and tracked links to the booking form, give influencers codes, and pause YouTube and Email (the weakest measured returns, ₦294M of spend so far) for eight weeks to see whether bookings move.

5

Book November–December crew in September.

Double bookings cluster in the peak; confirm freelancers early.

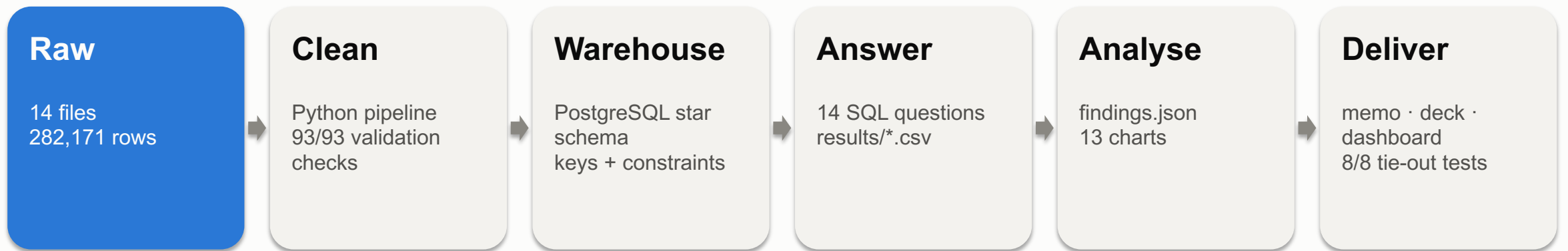
What could change the answer

Read these before quoting any number outside this room.

- No rent, equipment, salary, tax or bank data was provided. The cash explanation is an inference from what is missing, not a measurement; the bank statement would confirm or overturn it.
- Job status is a snapshot from mid-2025. 'Invoiced' is read as billed but unpaid; if finance marks paid invoices differently, the uncollected figure falls.
- 6.9% of revenue (~~N~~1.44B) is touched by data problems that could not be resolved, mostly 107 non-cancelled jobs with no service type. ~~N~~3.87B of bookings have no lead source.
- Merch revenue counts Pending orders (~~N~~302M); if they never ship, merch revenue is that much lower.

How this was built

Every number is reproducible from the raw files with one command.



- Nothing in raw/ is edited by the pipeline; it reads raw_original_backup/ and every rejected row lands in quarantine with a reason.
- Every decision is logged with its evidence: cleaning_report/CLEANING_DECISIONS.md, warehouse/WAREHOUSE_DECISIONS.md.
- The dashboard (Production · Merch · Acquisition) reads the same warehouse and is tested to tie to the SQL answers.